THE SESSION · POST-CLOSE READ

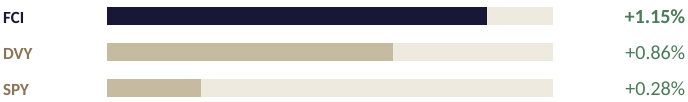
Dow Leads, *AI Slips*

The S&P 500 rose 0.33% and the Dow gained 1.08% while Treasury yields eased and AI-linked stocks fell, with the Nasdaq edging up 0.07% and Brent holding near $106 a barrel. Dividend Strategy +1.15% beat DVY and SPY; Growth Portfolio +1.35% beat IUSG.

S&P 500 ▲ 0.33% NASDAQ ▲ 0.07% DOW ▲ 1.08% VIX ▼ 2.37% BRENT ▼ 0.24%

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ▲ BEAT DVY + SPY

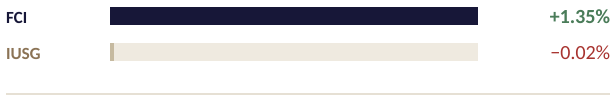
+1.15% 1-DAY



YTD **+19.93%** vs DVY +14.59% · SPY +14.06%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ▲ BEAT IUSG

+1.35% 1-DAY



YTD **+19.59%** vs IUSG +15.37%

THE SESSION

Stocks finished higher on Thursday as gains across most of the market outweighed a further decline in AI-linked stocks, while Treasury yields eased. The S&P 500 rose 0.33% to 7,744 after erasing an early loss, the Dow rose 1.08% to 52,179 and the Nasdaq edged up 0.07% to 26,712; the VIX fell 2.37% to 16.47. The 10-year Treasury yield was about 5.08% late in the session, down from 5.19% a day earlier, even as an inflation report came in hotter than expected; weekly jobless claims were lower than forecast. Overseas, South Korea's Kospi fell about 7.6% and Japan's Nikkei fell about 4.9% as the AI-related decline spread. NVIDIA fell 1.84% and Taiwan Semiconductor fell 1.73% despite record third-quarter profit. Brent held near $106 a barrel, down 0.24%; IBIT rose 0.76% and ETHA rose 0.95%.

The Dividend Strategy rose 1.15%, ahead of DVY's 0.86% gain by 0.29 point and SPY's 0.28% gain by 0.87 point, with fifteen of twenty-five holdings higher. S&P Global rose 3.99% to $424.87 and added about 0.24 point, Waste Management rose 3.95% to $224.27 and added about 0.23 point, and Stryker rose 4.14% to $293.27, adding about 0.22 point. Lam Research fell 3.30% and subtracted about 0.11 point amid a sector decline in semiconductor stocks, Constellation Energy fell 1.62% and subtracted about 0.09 point, and Caterpillar fell 1.80%, subtracting about 0.06 point.

Sessions in which leadership shifts beneath a steady index tend to reward portfolios that own cash-generative businesses across several parts of the economy. Owners have historically tended to look through short-term crowding in any one theme. ***Think Like an Owner.***

The Growth Portfolio rose 1.35%, ahead of IUSG's 0.02% decline by 1.37 points, with fourteen of twenty-five holdings higher and eleven lower. ServiceNow rose 6.15% to $148.59 amid buying in enterprise software, adding about 0.51 point; Agnico Eagle rose 5.90% to $187.45 and added about 0.29 point, and SoFi rose 6.12% to $15.09, adding about 0.24 point. Keysight fell 4.36% and subtracted about 0.17 point, Vertiv fell 3.61% and subtracted about 0.14 point, and NVIDIA subtracted about 0.12 point. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +19.93% against DVY's +14.59%, a +5.34-point spread, with SPY at +14.06%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +19.59% against IUSG's +15.37%, a +4.22-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

PGY +6.54% GROWTH
Rose to $17.91 without a company-specific catalyst.

NOW +6.15% GROWTH
Rose to $148.59 amid buying in enterprise software.

SOFI +6.12% GROWTH
Rose to $15.09 without a company-specific catalyst.

AEM +5.90% GROWTH
Rose to $187.45 without a company-specific catalyst.

DECLINERS

KEYS −4.36% GROWTH
Fell to $342.04 amid a broader decline in AI-linked stocks.

VRT −3.61% GROWTH
Fell to $214.78 amid a broader decline in AI-linked stocks.

LRCX −3.30% DIVIDEND
Fell to $277.46 amid a sector decline in semiconductor stocks.

FAST −3.12% DIVIDEND
Fell to $50.38 without a company-specific catalyst.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY
+19.93%
vs DVY +14.59% / SPY +14.06%
Spread vs DVY **+5.34 pts**

GROWTH PORTFOLIO
+19.59%
vs IUSG +15.37%
Spread vs IUSG **+4.22 pts**

SOURCES

1. The Associated Press (via BNN Bloomberg), "More Drops for AI Stocks Drag Wall Street Lower After Whipping Around the World," Oct. 15, 2026.
2. SmallCapsDaily, "Stock Market Today: Dow Surges 500 Points as Treasury Yields Tumble, but AI Stocks Remain Under Pressure," Oct. 15, 2026.
3. Invezz, "ServiceNow Stock Rises 6% as Investors Rotate to Enterprise Software Stocks," Oct. 15, 2026.
4. U.S. Department of the Treasury, Daily Treasury Par Yield Curve Rates, Oct. 14, 2026.
5. Market data and economic calendar: Financial Modeling Prep. Strategy returns: Paradiem FCI portfolio records.